

EY open sources ZKP blockchain technology

Ernst and Young has released third-generation zero-knowledge proof (ZKP) blockchain technology to the public domain on the Ethereum public blockchain. This ZKP technology for the Ethereum blockchain was originally called Nightfall. As per the company, this will help to make private transactions on public blockchains more scalable. It will do so by reducing transaction costs by putting multiple private transfers together in a single transaction.



Paul Brody, EY global blockchain leader, said, "This technology is perhaps the most important EY blockchain milestone in making public blockchains scalable for the enterprise. In the prior iteration released in April 2019, public blockchains were already getting competitive with private networks. With this iteration, we cut the cost per transaction by more than 90 per cent again, making private transactions more accessible for mainstream business application."

The new components of the ZKP blockchain technology will include tools for batching multiple proofs together. It will also include a solution for reducing the size of an on-chain Merkle tree. This will allow for up to 20 transactions to be done at once. By doing this, the costs will be reduced to around US\$ 0.05 per transaction, according to EY.

closure, no new content, posts, comments, or quality ratings were accepted on the Narrative platform. On December 30, 2019, the platform shut down entirely.

Narrative is open sourcing its code base using the GPL v3.0 license. This copyleft licence aims to ensure the software is free for all its users.

The sale of the platform will include access to its domain name, custody of the NRVE smart contract and token keys. It will also include access to the platform's content, comments and member data. The company has requested that legally recognised entities interested in discussing the sale of the Narrative platform should mail their queries to it.

Google will pay for security improvements in open source projects

Google is modifying its reward programme that covers open source projects for security improvements, says a report by *Duo*. Now, the tech major will provide monetary support in advance, for projects that the participants do not have the financial resources to complete on their own.

The patch reward programme is a part of Google's vulnerability reward programme. It pays researchers rewards for discovering and submitting security flaws in certain Google products and services.

Google started this programme in 2013 to encourage maintainers of open source projects to work on security weaknesses.

The programme rewards developers for strengthening certain elements or eliminating vulnerable libraries. The rewards programme requires developers to submit their fixes to the maintainers of an open source project. This then gets submitted to Google and the company later considers it for a reward.

Now, Google will provide money upfront for some projects that aim to make security improvements but have financial constraints. Starting from January 2020, Google will provide monetary support of as much as US\$ 30,000 to projects, depending on the scope of the challenge they are working on, the report stated.

Most of the support will be reserved for large open source projects that make significant changes or bring in new developers. For smaller projects, Google will offer US\$ 5,000 to fix security problems, like improvements to sand-boxing or patching vulnerabilities.

Jan Keller, technical programme manager for security at Google, said that starting from January 1, 2020, the company will not only reward proactive security improvements after the work is completed but also complement the programme with upfront financial support.



'Microsoft Teams for Linux' is up for public preview

According to a report by *Techcrunch*, Microsoft has announced a public preview of its tool 'Microsoft Teams for Linux'. This is the first Office 365 tool that has been made available for the open source operating system.

By making it available for preview, the company aims to get feedback from the community and improve it before making it generally available. In a blog announcing the release, Microsoft said that the preview will enable high